

Please check the examination details below before entering your candidate information

Candidate surname	Other names
Centre Number	Candidate Number

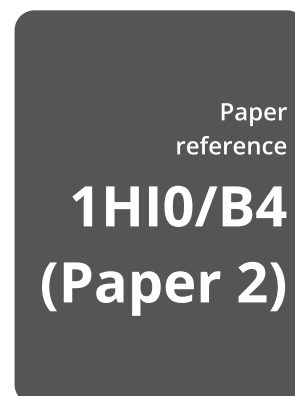
Pearson Edexcel GCSE (9-1)

Thursday 4 June 2026

Morning (Time: 1 hour 50 minutes -
total time for **both** booklets)

History

**BOOKLET B4: Early Elizabethan England,
1558-88**



You must have:

The corresponding booklet P.

Total Marks

Instructions

- Use **black** ink or ball-point pen.
- **Fill in the boxes** at the top of this page with your name, centre number and candidate number.
- There are two booklets in this question paper. **This is booklet B.**
- Answer questions 1(a), 1(b), 2 and **either 3 or 4** in this booklet.
- Check you have the corresponding booklet P.
- Answer the questions in the spaces provided
- *there may be more space than you need.*

Information

- The total mark for this booklet is 32.

- The total time for **both** booklets is 1 hour 50 minutes.
- The marks for **each** question are shown in brackets
- use this as a guide as to how much time to spend on each question.
- **Do not forget to complete booklet P.**

Advice

- Read each question carefully before you start to answer it.
- Try to divide your time equally between each booklet of the question paper.
- Check your answers if you have time at the end.

©2026 Pearson Education Ltd.

Turn over ► Pearson

Early Elizabethan England, 1558-88

Answer Question 1(a), Question 1(b), Question 2 and EITHER Question 3 OR Question 4.

1 (a) Describe one feature of the theatre in early Elizabethan England. (2)

(b) Describe one feature of the 1572 Vagabonds Act. (2)

(Total for Question 1 = 4 marks)

2 Explain why Mary, Queen of Scots, was executed in 1587.

(12)

You **may** use the following in your answer:

- the Babington Plot
- the Privy Council

*You **must** also use information of your own.*

Turn over ►

(Total for Question 2 = 12 marks)
Turn over ►

Answer EITHER Question 3 OR Question 4.

EITHER

- 3** 'The nature and extent of the Catholic challenge was a greater threat to Elizabeth's religious settlement than the Puritan challenge in the years 1559–69.'

How far do you agree? Explain your answer.

*You **may** use the following in your answer:*

- the role of the nobility
- the nature and extent of the Puritan challenge

*You **must** also use information of your own.*

(Total for Question 3 = 16 marks)

OR

- 4** 'The development of the theatre was the most significant change to leisure in early Elizabethan England.'

How far do you agree? Explain your answer.

*You **may** use the following in your answer:*

- the groundlings
- sport, pastimes and the theatre

*You **must** also use information of your own.*

(Total for Question 4 = 16 marks)

Chosen question number: Question 3 ☐ Question 4 ☐

Page 8 of 13

This image shows a full page of a document template designed for handwritten notes or essays. It features approximately 30 evenly spaced, thin grey horizontal lines extending across the entire width of the page. The background is plain white, providing a clear space for writing. There are no margins, headers, footers, or other graphical elements present.

[illegible]

[illegible]

TOTAL FOR BOOKLET B = 32 MARKS

PLEASE ENSURE YOU ALSO COMPLETE BOOKLET P.

BLANK PAGE

DO NOT WRITE ON THIS PAGE